

Landmarks: Natural and Man-Made

Lesson 3.06.03 | Week 16 | The Great Map Room

SS.3.G.2.1 | SS.3.G.2.4 | SS.3.G.4.1

Thinking Move: Notice | Name | Narrate

THE LANDMARK PHOTO WALL

A long wall of framed photos has just been unveiled.

Some photos show land that nature shaped over millions of years.

Others show places people built.

Right now they're hung in no particular order.

CHAT FRAME

"Last time we learned the land -- mountains, rivers, plains, islands."

"Now we're going to study famous spots inside that land."

"Some were made by nature, some were built by people."

Courtesy

Many landmarks are sacred or important to the people who live near them.

The pyramid of Chichen Itza was built by the Maya people more than 1,000 years ago.

The Statue of Liberty welcomes new neighbors to the United States.

Curators study these places carefully -- and respectfully.

YOUR ROLE

Regional Curator

Your job: help visitors recognize the famous places that make this region special. Today you'll sort landmark photos and write a caption.

What is the difference between a natural landmark and a man-made landmark -- and what can landmarks tell us about a place?

TODAY'S OBJECTIVES

Tell the difference between natural and man-made landmarks.

Name famous landmarks from North America and the Caribbean.

Explain what one landmark tells us about its place.

YOU'LL NEED

Curator's Notebook

Pencil

Lesson Page

What Is a Landmark?

A landmark is a place so famous, important, or unique that people travel from far away just to see it.

Every region has landmarks. They help visitors recognize a place the moment they see a photo of it.

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *What famous places have you heard of or seen in photos?*
- *Why do people travel a long way to stand in front of a place?*
- *Could you recognize a place just from its photo?*

INSERT IMAGE

*Collage of 6 landmark thumbnails:
Grand Canyon, Niagara Falls, Caribbean
Coral Reef,
Statue of Liberty, Chichen Itza, CN Tower*

Two Kinds of Landmarks

NATURAL LANDMARKS

Made by nature over a very long time -- wind, water, ice, or movement deep inside the Earth. People did not build them.

Grand Canyon -- carved by the Colorado River over millions of years

Niagara Falls -- shaped by water flowing over a cliff edge

Caribbean Coral Reefs -- built by tiny sea creatures over thousands of years

MAN-MADE LANDMARKS

Built by people. Someone designed and constructed them on purpose.

Statue of Liberty -- a gift from France in 1886

Chichen Itza Pyramid -- built by the Maya people over 1,000 years ago

CN Tower -- finished in Toronto in 1976; once the tallest building on Earth

A natural landmark tells us what the land does. A man-made landmark tells us what the people valued enough to build.

INSERT IMAGE

Wide photograph of the Grand Canyon, Arizona -- layered red and orange rock walls cut deep into the Earth, with the Colorado River visible at the bottom.

Source: [nps.gov/grca](https://www.nps.gov/grca), Library of Congress, USGS, or Wikimedia Commons (public domain)

Save as: source-3-06-03-grand-canyon.jpg

The Grand Canyon

Arizona, United States

Natural Landmark

Carved by the Colorado River over millions of years

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *How many layers of color can you spot in the rock walls?*
- *What's at the very bottom of the canyon?*
- *Did people build this? What do you think shaped it?*

INSERT IMAGE

Photograph of El Castillo, the great stepped pyramid at Chichen Itza, Yucatan, Mexico -- tall stone pyramid with stairs running up the front to a small temple on top.

Source: UNESCO (whc.unesco.org), Smithsonian, Library of Congress, or Wikimedia Commons

Save as: source-3-06-03-chichen-itza.jpg

Chichen Itza Pyramid

Yucatan, Mexico

Man-Made Landmark

Built by the Maya people
over 1,000 years ago

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *How is the pyramid shaped? How many sides does it have?*
- *What kinds of tools and effort would it take to build this from stone?*
- *What does this tell us about what the Maya people knew how to do?*

Natural or Man-Made?

Call out NATURAL or MAN-MADE for each landmark. Explain how you know.

Grand Canyon

NATURAL

Carved by the Colorado River over millions of years

Niagara Falls

NATURAL

Massive waterfall where the Niagara River drops over a cliff

Caribbean Coral Reefs

NATURAL

Underwater reefs built by tiny sea creatures over thousands of years

Statue of Liberty

MAN-MADE

A 305-foot copper statue; gift from France, 1886

Chichen Itza Pyramid

MAN-MADE

Stepped stone pyramid built by the Maya over 1,000 years ago

CN Tower

MAN-MADE

1,815-foot tower in Toronto, finished 1976

Teacher: Reveal answers one at a time. Ask students to explain HOW they know before showing the label.

Coral Reefs: The Tricky One

Coral reefs are built by tiny living animals called coral polyps -- but no person designed or made them.

They count as natural.

They're the only landmark on the wall that is still being built right now -- tiny polyps keep growing.

INSERT IMAGE

Close-up photo of a colorful Caribbean coral reef underwater, showing coral formations and small fish.

Source: NOAA (public domain) or Wikimedia Commons

THEN AND NOW

In the past, people traveled for weeks just to see a famous landmark. Today, we can see most landmarks on our screens in seconds. But people still travel to stand right in front of these places -- because a photo is never quite the same as being there.

Where Would You Put Mount Rushmore?

INSERT IMAGE

*Photograph of Mount Rushmore --
the mountain with four presidents' faces
carved into the rock.*

*Source: NPS (nps.gov) or
Wikimedia Commons (public domain)*

THE PUZZLE

It's a mountain (natural) -- but the faces of four presidents were carved into it by people (man-made).

Some landmarks are tricky.

Most curators count Mount Rushmore as man-made, because the famous part is what people added.

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *Why is Mount Rushmore tricky to classify?*
- *If the famous part is what people carved, does that make it man-made?*
- *Can you think of any other places that are a mix of both?*

What Do Landmarks Tell Us?

NATURAL LANDMARKS TELL US...

...what the land does.

The Grand Canyon tells us the Colorado River has been cutting through rock for millions of years. The land is powerful and ancient.

MAN-MADE LANDMARKS TELL US...

...what the people valued enough to build.

The Chichen Itza pyramid tells us the Maya people had great building skill and their beliefs mattered enough to build a giant stone monument.

EXHIBIT LABEL

Landmarks are famous places that help us recognize a region. Natural landmarks were shaped by nature; man-made landmarks were built by people. Together, they tell visitors what the land does and what the people who live there have done.

What is a landmark?

A. The capital city of a country.

B. A famous place that people travel to see.

C. A kind of map that shows borders.

Landmarks are famous places -- sometimes shaped by nature, sometimes built by people -- that visitors travel to see.

Which of these is a natural landmark?

A. The Grand Canyon

B. The CN Tower

C. The Statue of Liberty

The Grand Canyon was carved by the Colorado River over millions of years -- no person built it.

What do man-made landmarks tell us about a place?

A. How hot or cold the weather is there.

B. How big the country is.

C. What the people who live there valued enough to build.

When people spend years building something huge, it tells us what mattered to them.

Scaffolding: Evidence Question 1

What is the difference between a natural landmark and a man-made landmark? Give one example of each from today's lesson.

SENTENCE STARTERS

A natural landmark is... One example is...

A man-made landmark is... One example is...

The difference is that natural landmarks were _____, but man-made landmarks were _____.

MODEL ANSWER

A natural landmark was made by nature over a long time. Niagara Falls is natural because the Niagara River made it by dropping over a cliff. A man-made landmark was built by people. The Statue of Liberty is man-made because it was a gift from France in 1886.

Scaffolding: Evidence Question 2

Pick the Chichen Itza pyramid. What does it tell us about the people who built it? Use one detail from the lesson.

THINK THROUGH IT

What is it?

A stepped stone pyramid in the Yucatan, Mexico

Who built it?

The Maya people, over 1,000 years ago

What does that tell us?

They had the skill to build something huge from stone; their beliefs mattered enough to build a monument

CHAT FRAME

"The Chichen Itza pyramid tells us the Maya people..."

"One detail from the lesson is..."

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *What did it take to build a stone pyramid over 1,000 years ago?*
- *What does building something that big tell us about what mattered to the*

Curator Task: Photo Caption

Pick one landmark from today's lesson (Grand Canyon, Niagara Falls, Caribbean Coral Reefs, Statue of Liberty, Chichen Itza, or CN Tower). Write a 3-4 sentence caption that visitors will read under its photo. Include: the landmark's name, where it is (country or region), whether it is natural or man-made, and one thing it tells us about its place.

YOUR CAPTION SHOULD ANSWER

What is this landmark?

Where is it?

Natural or man-made?

What does it tell us about its place?

CURATOR'S CHRONICLE

Finish this sentence in your own words:

***In this exhibit, I learned that _____
because _____.***

What You'll Turn In

EVIDENCE Q1

What is the difference between a natural landmark and a man-made landmark? Give one example of each from today's lesson.

EVIDENCE Q2

Pick the Chichen Itza pyramid. What does it tell us about the people who built it? Use one detail from the lesson.

CURATOR TASK

Photo Caption: 3-4 sentences about one landmark (name, location, natural/man-made, what it tells us about its place).

CHRONICLE: In this exhibit, I learned that _____ because _____.

Great Work, Regional Curator!

You sorted the Landmark Photo Wall, studied two real photos, and wrote a caption that explains what one landmark tells us about its place.

COMING NEXT

Climate and Vegetation Across the Region

Brand-new panels have been wheeled into the gallery -- long, colorful displays showing the region's climate and plant life, stretching from the icy north to the tropical south. Next time, you'll figure out why the land in one part of the region looks so different from another.